Ershad Kunnakkadan

Product-Minded Engineer

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Software Engineer turned CEO with deep expertise in infrastructure, security, and scalable systems. Recognized by the U.S. government as an individual with extraordinary ability (O-1A visa). Progressed from hands-on engineer to leading Gumroad as CEO, responsible for company strategy, AI adoption, product vision, and long-term growth. Background includes open source contributions to Gumroad, GitLab and Wikimedia, security research recognized by GitHub, and mentoring through Google Summer of Code.

Technical skills

Languages Ruby, Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, Go, Elixir, C, C++, Lua, HCL, Shell Script, HTML/CSS/Haml/SaSS

Frameworks Ruby on Rails, Phoenix, WebDriverIO, ReactJS, AngularJS

DevOps AWS, Heroku, Cloudflare, DigitalOcean, Docker, Ansible, Chef, Terraform, Nomad, Consul, Vault, Okta

Databases PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB

Work Experience and Positions

November 2025 – March 2026
Chief Executive Officer, *Gumroad Inc*, New York, https://gumroad.com.
Led Gumroad's overall strategy, product direction, and operations. Accountable for company performance, culture, and long term growth.

January 2025 – November 2025
Staff Software Engineer, *Gumroad Inc*, New York, https://gumroad.com.
Moved to New York on O-1A visa for individuals with extraordinary ability. Staff Engineer for infrastructure, security and performance.

June 2020 – December 2024
Senior Software Engineer, *Gumroad Inc*, Remote, https://gumroad.com.
Full-stack developer and lead engineer for infrastructure, security and performance.

July 2015 – June 2020
Senior Software Engineer, *BigBinary*, Remote, https://bigbinary.com.
Full-stack developer, consulted for various clients of BigBinary.

Jan 2013 – July 2015
Software Architect, *BangTheTable, Bangalore*, https://bangthetable.com.
Lead of one of the software engineering teams. Designed and implemented solutions for the flagship product EngagementHQ while taking care of its DevOps, scalability and security.

May 2012 – Dec 2012
Software Engineer, *BangTheTable, Bangalore*, https://bangthetable.com.
Contributed to the development of various software products of Bang the Table.

Mar 2012 – Apr 2012
Developer Intern, *BangTheTable, Bangalore*, https://bangthetable.com.
Learned and developed software for BangTheTable.

Education

- Bachelor's degree in Computer Science from Bharathiyar University, India.

Google Summer of Code (GSoC)

2014
Language detection and filter in Diaspora, *Swathanthra Malayalam Computing*.
Mentored and assessed the work of Google Summer of Code participants.

2013 **Grandham - Bibliography data project**, *Swathanthra Malayalam Computing*.
Built Grandham platform and APIs. Successfully completed the project.

Security Bounty

- **GitHub** – https://bounty.github.com/researchers/ershad.html
  Found a security vulnerability in GitHub Gist.

- **Prezi.com** – https://prezi.com/bugbounty/whitehats
  Found a security vulnerability which exposed title of presentations in database.

Open Source Contributions

2017 **GitLab, Inc.**, Built a feature to directly address users in description / comments., http://contributors.gitlab.com/contributors/ershad-kunnakkadan/commits.

2012 **Wikimedia**, Fixed issues related to Universal Language Selector, https://wikimedia.org.

2009 – Present **Swathanthra Malayalam Computing**, Developed and translated applications for the local community, https://smc.org.in.

Blogs

- **BigBinary Blog** – https://blog.bigbinary.com/authors/ershad
  Wrote technical posts on Ruby on Rails and DevOps.

- **Personal Blog** – http://blog.ershadk.com

Achievements

Nov 2012 **Hackathon**, *Wikimedia Foundation*.
Won the prize for 'The most innovative project' in Wikimedia DevCamp conducted at IIM Bangalore

Jul 2012 **Hackathon**, *Innoz technologies, Bangalore*.
Won third prize in the National Level Hackathon conducted at Innoz technologies, Bangalore

Mar 2012 **Shell Scripting Contest**, *Saintgits College of Engineering, Kottayam*.
Won first prize in the National Level Shell scripting competition conducted as a part of Nakshatra Tech fest

Feb 2012 **Shell Scripting Contest – Scriptaculous**, *TKM College of Engineering, Kollam*.
Won first prize in the National Level Shell scripting competition conducted as a part of Conjura Tech fest

Feb 2012 **Virus infiltration and healing competition – Virus Evacuation**, *College of Engineering Kallooppara, Pathanamthitta*.
Won first prize in the National Level Virus Healing Contest conducted as a part of Dhanus Tech fest

Feb 2012 **Linux administation and bash scripting competition – Linux Guru**, *College of Engineering Kallooppara, Pathanamthitta*.
Won first prize in the National Level Linux based Contest conducted as a part of Dhanus Tech fest

Feb 2012 **Ethical Hacking Contest – Haxploit**, *Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham, Kollam.*
Won first prize in the National Level Ethical Hacking Contest conducted as a part of Vidyut Tech fest

Feb 2012 **Developing Software Bot Contest – Botomatic**, *Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham, Kollam.*
Won first prize in the National Level Software Bot Developing Contest conducted as a part of Vidyut Tech fest

Oct 2011 **Shell Scripting Contest – Tux of War**, *National Institute of Technology, Calicut.*
Won first prize in the National Level Shell Scripting Contest conducted as a part of Tathva Tech fest

Sep 2011 **Shell Scripting Contest – #!/bin/bash**, *Model Engineering College, Cochin.*
Won first prize in the National Level Shell Scripting Contest conducted as a part of Excelmec Tech fest

Feb 2011 **Paper Presentation Competition: Git Verson Control System**, *Nehru College of Engineering and Research Centre,Thrissur.*
Won first prize in the Paper Presentation Competition conducted as a part of Prayaana Tech fest

Talks and Workshops

Feb 2014 **Programming in Ruby for fun and profit**, *National Institute of Technology, Calicut.*
Led a workshop introducing ruby and its industry applications

Jan 2014 **Ruby Programming Language**, *NSS College of Engineering, Palakkad.*
Led a workshop in programming in Ruby

Sep 2012 **Git Version Control System**, *MES College of Engineering, Kuttippuram, Malappuram.*
Led a workshop on Git Version Control System

Apr 2012 **Introduction to free software**, *MES College of Engineering, Kuttippuram, Malappuram.*
Presented a talk on free software and package management in debian

Jan 2012 **Free software and web technologies**, *NSS College of Engineering, Palakkad.*
Presented a talk on free software and web technologies

Jan 2012 **GNU/Linux Command line tools and Shell scripting**, *NSS College of Engineering, Palakkad.*
Led a workshop on GNU/Linux command line tools and shell scripting

Sep 2011 **Git Version Control System**, *NSS College of Engineering, Palakkad.*
Led a workshop on Git Version Control System

Aug 2011 **Fun with programming and introduction to Free Software**, *NSS College of Engineering, Palakkad.*
Presented an introductory talk on free software and how to have fun with programming

Jul 2011 **Fun with programming and introduction to Free Software**, *MES College of Engineering, Kuttippuram, Malappuram.*
Presented an introductory talk on free software and how to have fun with programming